Leadership Skills

What New Supervisors
And Managers Need to Know

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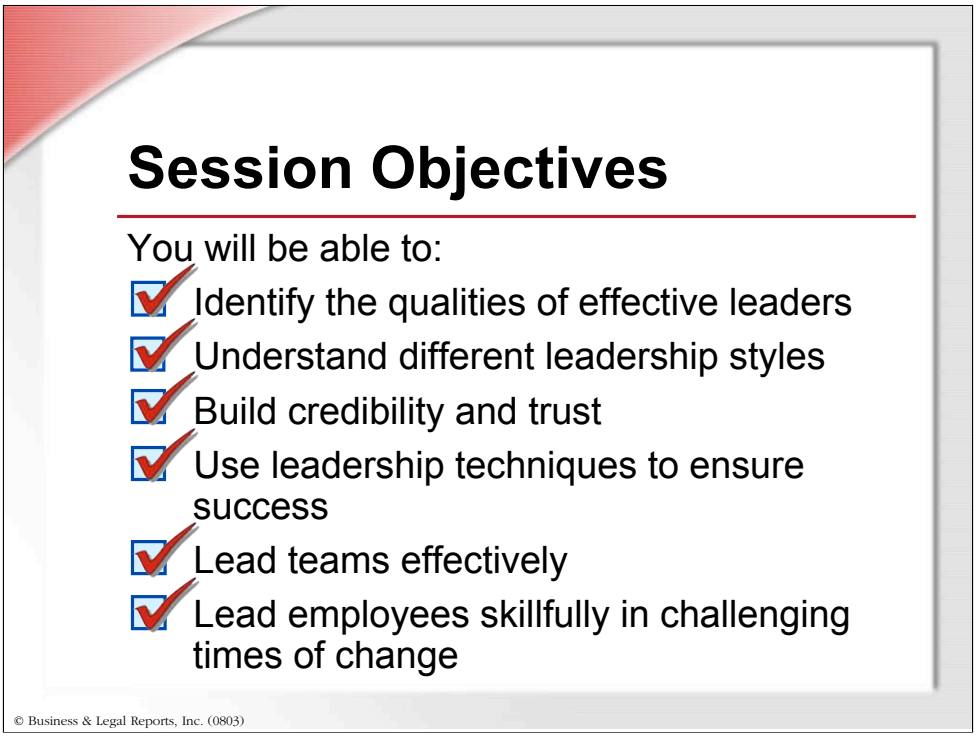
Slide Show Notes

- Leadership is an essential skill for all supervisors and managers, especially if you are new to the job. Truly successful supervisors and managers don't "boss" their employees, they lead them. It's through effective leadership that employees are motivated to perform at their best. It's through effective leadership that goals are achieved and your department meets productivity, quality, service, and safety standards.
- Today, we're going to talk about what it means to be an effective leader and provide you with the information you need to develop first-class leadership skills.



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The main objective of this session is to discuss the important supervisory and managerial topic of leadership and explain how you can become a more effective leader. By the time this session is over, you should be able to:

- Identify the qualities of effective leaders;
- Understand different leadership styles;
- Build credibility and trust;
- Use leadership techniques to ensure success;
- Lead teams effectively; *and*
- Lead employees skillfully in challenging times of change.

What Is Leadership?

- Guiding people to take appropriate initiative
- The art of getting others to do things you want done
- Inspiring people
- Taking people where they need to be
- A skill that can be developed through hard work

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Perhaps the best way to define leadership is to let some experts in the subject tell you what they think the word means.

- General George Patton said, “Don’t tell people how to do things, tell them what to do and let them surprise you with their results.”
- President Dwight Eisenhower defined leadership as “the art of getting someone else to do something you want done because he wants to do it.”
- President John Quincy Adams said, “If your actions inspire others to dream more, learn more, do more and become more, you are a leader.”
- Former First Lady Rosalyn Carter said that “a leader takes people where they want to go. A great leader takes people where they don't necessarily want to go, but ought to be.”
- Football coach Vince Lombardi said, “Leaders are made, they are not born. They are made by hard effort, which is the price which all of us must pay to achieve any goal that is worthwhile.”

What Is Leadership? (cont.)

- Having a vision
- Simplifying and offering solutions everybody can understand
- Empowerment
- "Growing" others
- Lifting aspirations, raising performance, and building beyond limitations

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- Former Notre Dame President Theodore Hesburgh said that "the very essence of leadership is that you have to have vision."
- General Colin Powell said, "Great leaders are almost always great simplifiers, who can cut through argument, debate, and doubt to offer a solution everybody can understand."
- Chinese philosopher Lao-Tzu said that when a good leader's work is done, those he or she leads will say, "We did this ourselves."
- Former CEO of General Electric Jack Welch said, "Before you are a leader, success is all about growing yourself. When you become a leader, success is all about growing others."
- Management expert Peter Drucker said, "Leadership is lifting a person's vision to higher sights, the raising of a person's performance to a higher standard, the building of a personality beyond its normal limitations."

Leadership and Power

- Commanding and understanding
- Directing and consulting
- Ordering and asking

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Sometimes people confuse leadership with power. Leaders are often portrayed as hard-driving, hardnosed, and headstrong. And many good leaders have those qualities to be sure. But it takes both force and influence to lead others effectively. The two approaches complement each other and create a powerful, yet adaptable force for action. Good leadership always balances power and influence.

- For example, good leaders must be both commanding and understanding. A leader must know how to take command and run a department or work group. At the same time he or she must be understanding and take the needs of each group member into account.
- Leaders must direct as well as consult. They have to be able to direct operations and activities, but they also need to consult those they lead and listen to their ideas and opinions.
- Leaders must develop a balance between ordering and asking. They have to know how to give orders when necessary, and they know when it is more effective to ask for cooperation.

Leadership and Power (cont.)

- Striving and yielding
- Strong and flexible
- Controlling and influencing

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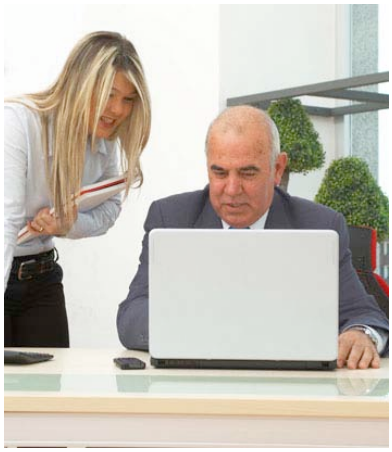
- Leaders must be striving yet yielding. They need to strive for success, but they must also know when to go around a barrier rather than try to break through it.
- Good leaders are both strong and flexible—just like the best athletes. Leaders must know when to stand firm and when to bend.
- Finally, sometimes leaders need to be controlling and sometimes they must rely on influence. They have to be able to control situations and groups, but they also need to know how to influence, facilitate, and work from within the group—or even from behind the scenes.

Think about the way you lead your employees. Do you balance your power over employees with influence, persuasion, and guidance? Do you "boss" your employees or do you work with them, facilitating and empowering them?

Discuss the relationship between power and influence and how that affects a person's effectiveness as a leader. Ask trainees to give examples of how they have used influence to get employees to do what needed to be done rather than just ordering them to do it.

What Are the Qualities Of Effective Leaders?

- Good with people
- Motivated
- Competent
- Self-aware
- Good communicators



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Effective leaders possess a number of essential qualities that allow them to function successfully and lead their employees to meet challenges and accomplish goals.

- Effective leaders are good with people. They appreciate diversity and get along well with all kinds of people. They also understand the importance of teamwork and cooperation.
- The best leaders are also highly motivated. They know how to inspire themselves and their employees to achieve, even when the going gets tough.
- Effective leaders are competent. They have the knowledge and skills to perform at their best. They keep up to date and are always open to learning something new.
- In addition, good leaders are always self-aware. They learn from experience. They recognize both their strengths and their weaknesses. They understand how their words and actions affect others.
- Finally, the best leaders are good communicators, too. They express themselves clearly and directly. They listen actively to others and give positive, honest feedback.

What Are the Qualities Of Effective Leaders? (cont.)

- Wise
- Farsighted
- Action-oriented
- Flexible
- Persistent

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- Good leaders are also wise. By this, we mean they have good judgment and use it to make good decisions, even under pressure.
- They are farsighted. Effective leaders have the vision and creativity to see possibilities and potential where others might see only problems.
- Leaders are always action-oriented. When they see something that needs to be done, they do it. They enjoy challenges.
- Good leaders are also flexible. They can handle uncertainty and adapt to change.
- Effective leaders are persistent. They can deal with adversity and know how to turn problems into opportunities. They don't believe in giving in or giving up. They trust their ability to get the job done no matter what.

What Are the Qualities Of Effective Leaders? (cont.)

- Positive
- Respectful
- Caring and committed
- Credible and trusted
- Goal-oriented

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- Effective leaders are positive people. They are convinced of their ability to meet challenges and overcome obstacles, and they instill their positive attitude in their employees.
- Good leaders are also respectful—and respected as a result. They treat everyone as they wish to be treated.
- The best leaders are caring and committed. They care about their employees. They care about their jobs. And they are committed to the organization and its mission.
- Good leaders are credible and trusted. They are honest and straightforward. Both their managers and their employees believe them and trust them.
- Finally, effective leaders are goal-oriented. They are always able to keep the big picture in sight. They know how to inspire employees to focus on and achieve goals.

Think about these qualities and how they contribute to effective leadership. Can you think of any other qualities of effective leaders?

Discuss the qualities of effective leaders. Ask trainees to suggest other qualities that would make someone a good leader.

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In addition to the qualities we've just discussed, you should be familiar with different leadership styles as well. Any one of them can be effective depending on the circumstances and the employees involved. Today, we'll focus on four basic leadership styles.

- The authoritative style is often effective when dealing with new and inexperienced workers or in times of crisis when employees need to feel reassured by a strong leader at the helm. Authoritative leadership:
  - Communicates from top to bottom;
  - Provides solid direction;
  - Wastes no time getting things done;
  - Consolidates decision making in the hands of the leader;
  - Provides a secure position for dependent employees; *and*
  - Offers a tightly organized and efficient work environment.
- The *laissez-faire* style works well with experienced, well-trained, self-directed employees. *Laissez-faire* leadership:
  - Draws ideas from employees;
  - Usually communicates upward; *and*
  - Often places responsibility for outcomes on employees.

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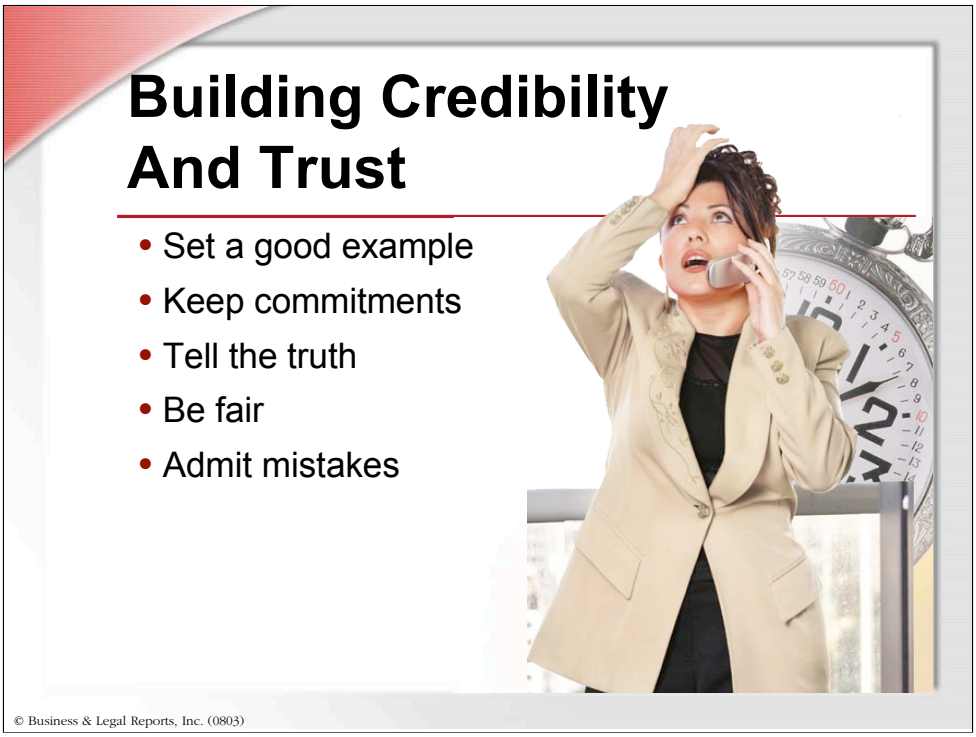
- The social leadership style is inclusive and supportive. It is:
  - Action-oriented;
  - Participative;
  - Encouraging of innovation and creativity;
  - Supportive and forgiving;
  - Positive and upbeat; *and*
  - Reward-oriented.
- The team leadership style also encourages employee participation and initiative. Team leadership:
  - Maximizes employee efforts;
  - Encourages two-way communication;
  - Creates an atmosphere of mutual trust, respect, and understanding;
  - Involves employees in decision making and problem solving;
  - Encourages creativity and initiative; *and*
  - Fosters enthusiasm and a sense of belonging.

The most effective leaders create their own style by combining and blending different styles to suit different challenges and situations.



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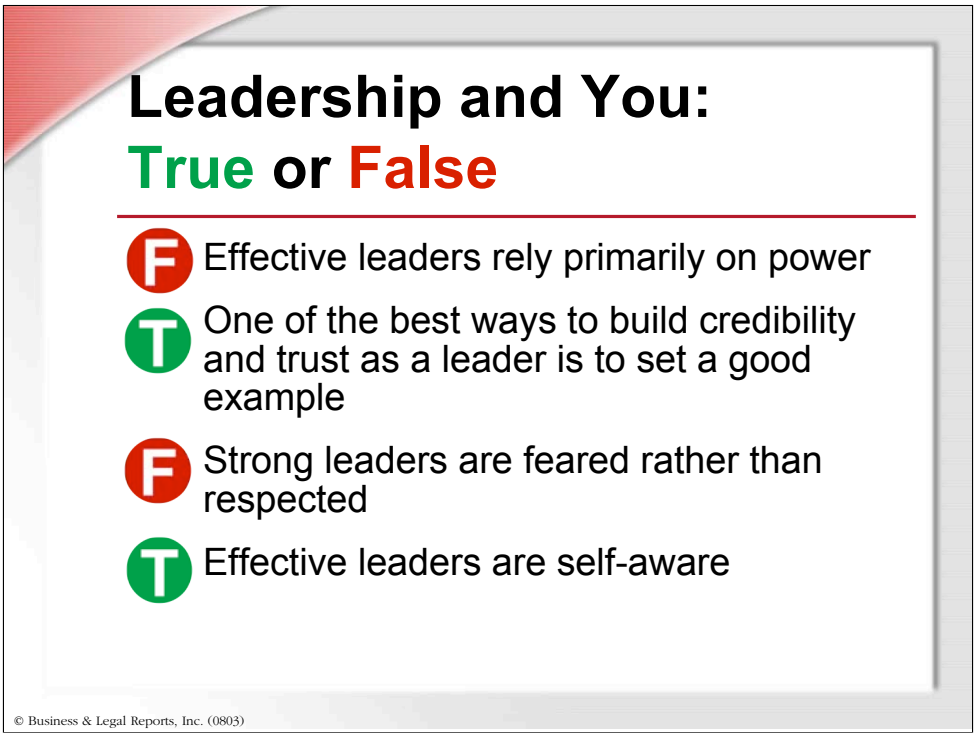
One of the most important things effective leaders can do—regardless of their leadership style—is to build credibility and trust with everyone they work with. Here are some tips for building credibility and trust.

- Always set a good example. Leaders never say, "Do as I say, not as I do." They do as they expect their employees to do.
- Keep commitments. Nothing destroys credibility quicker than when someone in a leadership position fails to make good on commitments. It's better not to make a promise or commitment than to fail to deliver.
- Always tell the truth. Of course, sometimes you must keep confidences or be judicious about the information you share. But make sure what you do say is true. Once you're caught in a lie, your credibility will always be in question.
- Be fair, too. If you want employees to trust you, you have to have their best interests at heart. You have to treat them all fairly and provide equal opportunity.
- To build credibility and trust, you also have to admit your mistakes and encourage employees to do the same. We're all human. We all make mistakes. The successful leader admits mistakes, learns from them, and moves on.



Slide Show Notes

OK. Let's take a few minutes now to test your knowledge of the information presented in the previous slides. Your job is to decide whether each of the statements on the screen is **true** *or* **false**. Let's begin.

- Effective leaders rely primarily on power. True or false? The correct answer is **false**. Effective leaders balance power with influence.
- One of the best ways to build credibility and trust as a leader is to set a good example. True or false? The correct answer is **true**.
- Strong leaders are feared rather than respected. True or false? The correct answer is **false**. The best leaders are respected—and respectful of others.
- Effective leaders are self-aware. True or false? The correct answer is **true**. They know their strengths and their weaknesses and they learn from experience.

How did you do? Did you get all the answers right?

Leadership and You

Do you understand:

- What leadership is?
- Balance between leadership and power?
- Qualities of effective leaders?
- Leadership styles?
- How to build credibility and trust?

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Now it's time to ask yourself if you understand the information presented so far. Do you understand:

- What leadership is?
- The balance between leadership and power?
- The qualities of effective leaders?
- Leadership styles?
- How to build credibility and trust?

It's important for you to understand all this information to be an effective leader.

Answer any questions trainees have about the information presented in the previous slides.

Conduct an exercise, if appropriate.

Let's continue to the next slide now and talk about leadership techniques.

Basic Leadership Techniques

- Empowerment
- Motivation
- Delegation
- Accountability
- Participation
- Feedback

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To become outstanding in your job, you must be a good leader. Using the following six leadership techniques can help. They are:

- Empowerment,
- Motivation,
- Delegation,
- Accountability,
- Participation, *and*
- Feedback.

We'll look at each of these techniques in more detail in the next set of slides.

Slide Show Notes

As the Chinese philosopher Lao-Tzu—who we quoted at the beginning of the session—said, when a good leader's work is done, those he or she leads will say, "We did this ourselves." That's what empowerment is all about, and it is a very powerful part of effective leadership in the workplace.

- To empower employees, you must begin by promoting a sense of ownership. Employees need to feel that they "own" their jobs and are responsible for their performance. You also have to encourage initiative among employees—always making sure that employees check with you before they take independent action, of course.
- To empower employees you also have to provide excellent training that gives workers the skills and knowledge they need to take charge of their jobs and meet required standards.
- And, empowerment is about team action, too. When you create work teams in which employees can work together to achieve goals, solve problems, and make decisions, you are likely to get better results as well as have more motivated and satisfied employees.

Empowerment (cont.)

- Be accessible for consultation
- Share credit and responsibility
- Recognize achievement

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- When you empower employees to act independently, you must always be accessible for consultation so that you can be sure they are taking the right actions at the right time.
- Empowerment is about sharing responsibility for achieving goals and credit for success as well. When you empower employees, of course, you must also be prepared to share responsibility for failure. You hope it doesn't happen, and you do everything possible to prevent it, but sometimes employees fail to achieve goals—either individually or in groups. When that happens, you need to be right there by their side and share responsibility for the outcome.
- Finally, to keep employees empowered, you need to recognize their achievements and reward successful performance.

Think about the steps you take to empower your employees. Are you incorporating the ideas presented in this slide?

Discuss the benefits of empowering employees and how to achieve this goal. Ask trainees to give examples of ways they empower their employees.

Slide Show Notes

Motivation helps you develop skilled, productive, quality-oriented workers who can take initiative, work well with others, and get the job done. Motivation is a cornerstone of effective leadership. Good leaders:

- Create a vision that helps employees see how they fit into the big picture;
- Provide clear direction so that workers know the parameters of successful performance;
- Have high expectations of all employees;
- Set reasonable, achievable goals;
- Maintain consistent standards; *and*
- Discover and use personal motivators.

This last point is especially important. Different people are motivated by different things. For some, it's opportunities for advancement, for others, it's challenging work, and for still others, it's support, security, and a sense of belonging to a group. Successful leaders get to know their employees and what motivates each one, and then use this information to elicit the best possible performance from each worker.

Delegation

- Determine the task
- Define the task
- Select the right person
- Explain the task
- Provide support and feedback
- Follow up

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Delegation is an essential managerial skill that every leader must master. Effective delegation involves a six-step process.

- The first step is to determine the task. Some work only you, the leader, can do. But other tasks can be done just as well by someone else on your team, freeing you to do more of the work only you can do.
- The next step is to define the task. What needs to be done, step-by-step? You must have a firm grasp of what's involved in order to explain it to the person to whom you delegate the task.
- Then, you must select the right person for the job. You need to pick an employee who has the skills and the time to do the job well.
- Next, you have to carefully explain the task. Describe what needs to be done in detail and answer any questions.
- Then, you must provide support and feedback. Once the person begins the job, provide support and positive feedback to ensure success. Lend a helping hand and provide motivation as necessary.
- Finally, you have to follow up to make sure that the task has been performed completely and accurately.

Accountability

- Set appropriate standards
- Make sure employees understand expectations
- Monitor performance
- Provide support and assistance
- Evaluate performance
- Explain what to improve and how

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Slide Show Notes

Good leaders hold employees accountable for their performance. But they also work hard to make sure that employees have the best chance of succeeding. Accountability involves:

- Setting appropriate standards;
- Making sure employees understand expectations and how to achieve them;
- Monitoring performance to make sure workers are progressing properly;
- Providing support and assistance as needed;
- Evaluating performance to see if expectations have been met; *and*
- Explaining what employees need to do to improve performance and how to do that, if necessary.

Think about the ways you hold employees accountable for their work and for meeting required standards. It's an important part of your job as a leader.

Discuss the importance of accountability and the steps trainees can take to hold employees accountable while providing adequate support to ensure success.

Participation

- Interact with employees daily
- Ask for input
- Involve employees in decision making and problem solving
- Encourage all to speak up
- Reinforce participation

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Effective leaders understand that they depend on their employees as much as their employees depend on them. Therefore, they encourage participation in a variety of ways. For example:

- Encourage participation by interacting with employees daily. Talk to as many employees as you can everyday. Listen to their thoughts and concerns.
- Ask for their input and encourage them to share ideas and make suggestions for improvements of all kinds. Some employees might have great ideas but won't share them unless you ask.
- Involve employees in decision making and problem solving whenever possible. This will make them feel part of the operation of the department. It will also help give them a sense of ownership, which translates into commitment and the belief that their efforts matter.
- Encourage workers to speak up at group meetings and give their opinions, share their expertise, and build on one another's ideas.
- And, of course, reinforce participation by recognizing and rewarding those who participate. When those who are not yet participating see that, they, too, will participate.

How do you encourage participation? Do you use these methods?

Ask trainees to describe how they encourage participation.

Feedback

- Make feedback specific and timely
- Identify what was done well or poorly
- Explain why it is important
- Ask employee for input
- Limit feedback to one issue at a time
- Follow up and provide additional feedback

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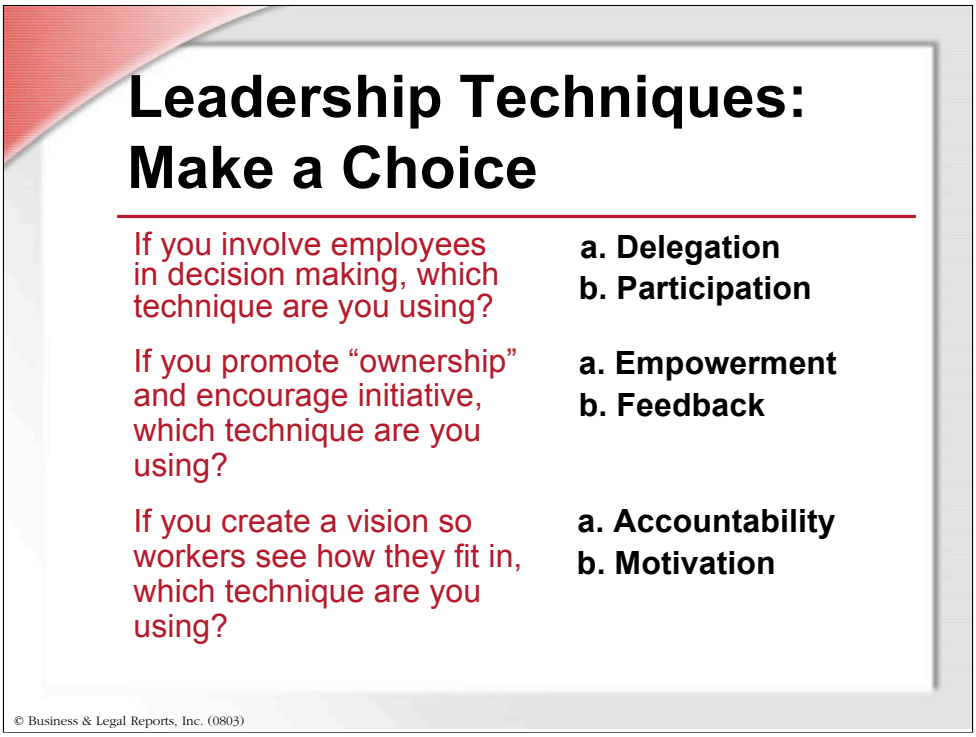
The final leadership technique we'll discuss today is feedback. Feedback helps you guide employees and mold behavior. It's an essential tool that successful leaders use liberally.

- When you give feedback to your employees, be sure to make it specific. Base it on a specific event, behavior, or action. Also make it timely. Give feedback as soon after the observed behavior or event that prompts the feedback.
- Identify what was done well or poorly. If you are correcting behavior, make sure to explain exactly what you expect the employee to do and how it is to be done.
- Also explain why it is important for the employee to follow your directions.
- Don't forget to ask the employee for his or her input. The best feedback always involves two-way communication.
- Limit feedback to one issue at a time. Generalized feedback or feedback on multiple issues is less effective.
- And, follow up with more feedback—positive or corrective—as needed.

Think about the feedback you give your employees about their performance. Does it motivate them to perform at their best?

Ask trainees to describe how they use feedback to motivate employees and encourage superior performance.



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Let's try a quick multiple choice quiz now to see how well you remember the information we've just discussed about leadership techniques. For each question choose the best answer, **a** *or* **b**. Let's begin.

- If you involve employees in decision making, which technique are you using? The best answer is **b**, participation. Of course, delegation might involve employees in some decision making, too, depending on the task and how much authority you delegate.
- If you promote "ownership" and encourage initiative, which technique are you using? The best answer is **a**, empowerment.
- If you create a vision so workers see how they fit in to the big picture, which technique are you using? The best answer is **b**, motivation.

How did you do? Did you get all the answers right?

Leadership Techniques

Do you understand:

- Empowerment?
- Motivation?
- Delegation?
- Accountability?
- Participation?
- Feedback?

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Do you understand all of the leadership techniques we've covered in the previous slides? For example, do you understand what we've said about:

- Empowerment?
- Motivation?
- Delegation?
- Accountability?
- Participation?
- Feedback?

Answer any questions trainees have about the information presented in the previous slides.

Conduct an exercise, if appropriate.

Now let's continue to the next slide and discuss the steps you can take to lead teams effectively.

Leading Teams

- Create the right atmosphere
- Set goals and build commitment
- Encourage participation and promote cooperation
- Provide support
- Maintain communication
- Resolve conflicts

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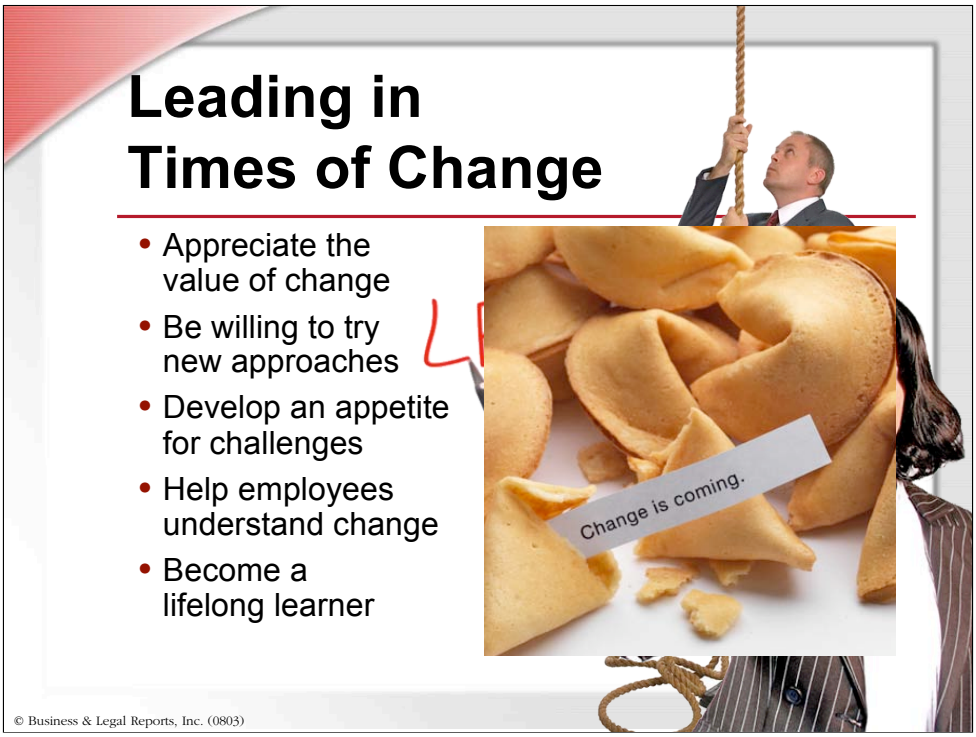
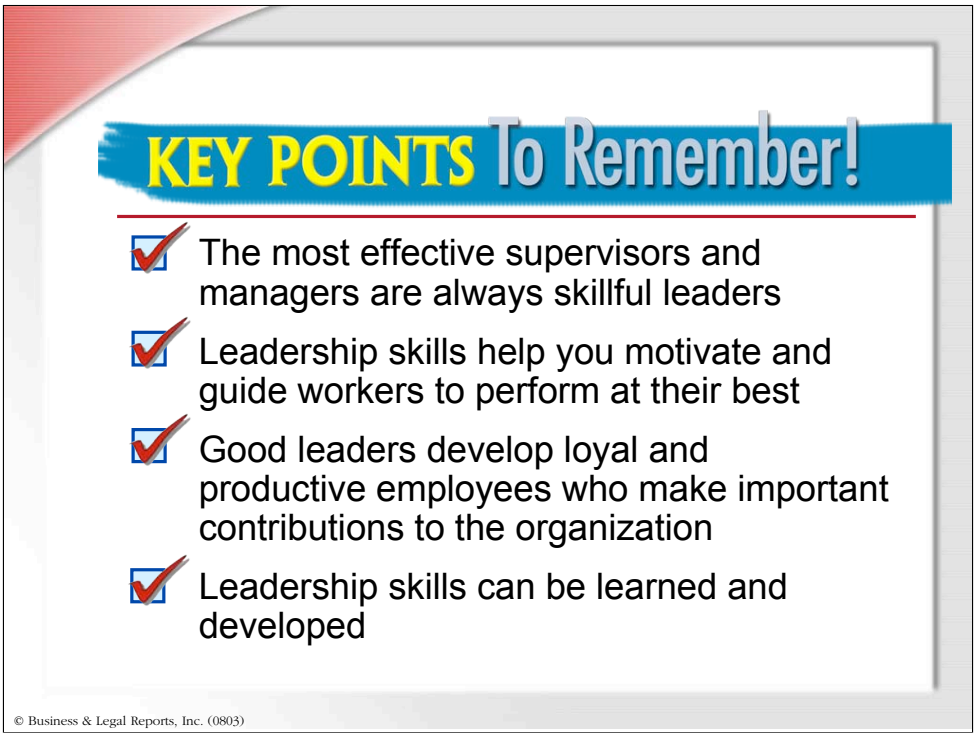
Teamwork is an important component of achieving quality and productivity goals in most organizations today. Here are some tips for leading teams effectively.

- Create an atmosphere in which people feel comfortable working together. Promote mutual respect and encourage different points of view.
- Set reasonable, clearly defined goals for the team and build commitment among team members by explaining the importance of the team's mission.
- Encourage participation and promote cooperation among team members.
- Also, provide support so that team members can accomplish their mission. Sometimes this might mean running interference for the team or providing information and additional resources.
- Maintain two-way communication between you and the team and among team members.
- Deal with conflict effectively. Good teams may disagree about methods, but a good leader makes sure that once discussion turns into conflict, any disagreement is dealt with promptly and successfully before it damages the team's cohesiveness and unity.



Slide Show Notes

- Leading change requires personal resiliency and a future-oriented outlook. To be a leader in changing times you must appreciate the value of change. Many people fear and therefore resist change. But leaders know that change is a positive and necessary force that makes the organization more efficient, better able to satisfy customers, more competitive, and more profitable.
- You must also be willing to try new ways of working and thinking. Change makes you and your employees stretch your minds and imaginations to see your work in a whole different light.
- And you have to develop an appetite for challenges. Change introduces a whole range of new situations and problems into employees' jobs. Leaders take up the challenge and persist in overcoming the obstacles.
- In addition, as a leader and a supervisor, you have to help employees understand and accept new policies, procedures, and so on. Leaders help others accept and become accustomed to change.
- Finally, leaders need to become lifelong learners. Those who lead change, rather than being left behind by it, realize that the next change is just around the corner and that they must always be learning something new in order to be ready for the next change.



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Here are the main points to remember from this session on leadership:

- The most effective supervisors and managers are always skillful leaders.
- Leadership skills help you motivate and guide workers to perform at their best.
- Good leaders develop loyal and productive employees who make important contributions to the organization.
- And finally, you don't have to be born a leader. Leadership skills can be learned and developed.

This concludes the leadership training session.

Give trainees the quiz, if appropriate.